Lianhua Qingwen Capsules - Efficacy and Properties Report

Abstract

This report provides comprehensive information on **Lianhua Qingwen Capsules**, a traditional Chinese medicine widely used for treating viral respiratory infections including influenza and COVID-19. The report covers drug composition, therapeutic effects, pharmacological mechanisms, clinical efficacy data, dosage guidelines, precautions, and internal company inventory status.

> ⚠️ **Important Notice:** Lianhua Qingwen is a treatment medication, NOT a preventive drug. Consult a physician or pharmacist before use.

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1. Drug Basic Information

Item	Details
Generic Name	Lianhua Qingwen Capsules
Drug Category	Traditional Chinese Medicine · Heat-clearing and Detoxifying Agent
Prescription Type	OTC Class A (Over-the-counter)
Approval Number	Z20040063
Manufacturer	Yiling Pharmaceutical Co., Ltd.

Item	Details
Dosage Form	Capsule
Strength per Capsule	0.35g / 0.4g
Common Specifications	0.35g × 24 capsules/plate; 0.35g × 36 capsules/plate
Shelf Life	30 months
Storage	Sealed, stored in a cool place (not exceeding 20°C)

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2. Main Ingredients

Lianhua Qingwen Capsules are composed of **13 Chinese herbal medicines**, combining the essence of two classic formulas: **Maxing Shigan Decoction** from *Treatise on Cold Pathogenic Diseases* and **Yinqiao San** from *Wenbing Tiaobian*, along with modern validated heat-clearing and detoxifying herbs.

2.1 Ingredient List

No.	Herb	Amount (per capsule)	Role	Function
1	Lianqiao (Forsythia)	255mg	Chief Drug	Clear heat, detoxify, disperse wind-heat

No.	Herb	Amount (per capsule)	Role	Function
2	Jinyinhua (Honeysuckle)	255mg	Chief Drug	Clear heat, detoxify, disperse wind-heat
3	Zhi Ma Huang (Prepared Ephedra)	85mg	Deputy Drug	Disseminate lung heat, relieve cough
4	Chao Ku Xing Ren (Stir-baked Apricot Seed)	85mg	Deputy Drug	Descend Qi, stop cough and asthma
5	Shi Gao (Gypsum)	255mg	Deputy Drug	Clear heat, drain fire, alleviate restlessness
6	Banlangen (Isatis Root)	255mg	Assistant Drug	Clear heat, detoxify, cool blood
7	Mian Ma Guan Zhong (Dryopteris Crinitis Rhizome)	255mg	Assistant Drug	Clear heat, detoxify, kill parasites
8	Yu Xing Cao (Houttuynia)	255mg	Assistant Drug	Clear heat, detoxify, resolve abscesses

No.	Herb	Amount (per capsule)	Role	Function
9	Guang Huo Xiang (Patchouli)	85mg	Envoy Drug	Resolve dampness, harmonize middle jiao
10	Bo He Nao (Menthol)	7.5mg	Envoy Drug	Disperse wind-heat, clear head and eyes
11	Da Huang (Rhubarb)	51mg	Envoy Drug	Purge heat, promote bowel movement
12	Hong Jing Tian (Rhodiola)	85mg	Qi-tonifying	Invigorate qi and blood, clear lung
13	Gan Cao (Licorice Root)	85mg	Harmonizing	Harmonize all ingredients, relieve urgency

Excipients: Corn starch

2.2 Formula Characteristics

The formula embodies four treatment principles: **"Clear, Disperse, Drain, Unblock"**

- **Clear:** Multiple heat-clearing and detoxifying herbs (Lianqiao, Jinyinhua, Banlangen, Yu Xing Cao) work together to eliminate heat toxins;

- **Disperse:** Zhi Ma Huang disseminates lung Qi, providing pathways for pathogens to exit;
- **Drain:** Shi Gao clears excess heat from lungs and stomach; Da Huang purges heat through bowels;
- **Unblock:** Hong Jing Tian invigorates qi and blood circulation; Guang Huo Xiang resolves dampness and harmonizes spleen and stomach.

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3. Therapeutic Effects

3.1 Indications

Core Action: Clear plague toxins, detoxify, disseminate lung, and purge heat.

TCM Syndrome Pattern: Heat-toxin attacking the lung syndrome.

3.2 Target Symptoms

Lianhua Qingwen Capsules are suitable for patients presenting the following symptoms:

Symptom Category	Manifestations
Fever-related	Fever or high fever, chills, muscle soreness
Nasal symptoms	Nasal congestion, runny nose
Respiratory symptoms	Cough, thick yellow phlegm
Head/facial symptoms	Headache, dry throat, sore throat
Tongue/pulse signs	Red tongue, yellow or greasy yellow coating

3.3 Applicable vs. Non-applicable Users

APPROPRIATE FOR: - Patients diagnosed with "Heat-toxin attacking lung syndrome" in TCM; - Those with predominant high fever, severe headache, marked throat pain, and thick yellow sputum; - People falling under wind-heat cold or heat syndrome patterns.

NOT appropriate for: - Wind-cold cold sufferers with heavy chills, mild fever, no sweating, clear nasal discharge, white thin phlegm; - Cold constitution individuals who always feel cold and have loose stools; - Healthy asymptomatic persons: Lianhua Qingwen is for treatment, not prevention.

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4. Modern Pharmacological Research

4.1 Broad-spectrum Antiviral Activity

Lianhua Qingwen demonstrates inhibitory effects against multiple respiratory viruses:

Virus Type	Inhibition Effect	Notes
Influenza A H1N1	Significant inhibition	Confirmed in vitro and in vivo
Influenza A H3N2	Significant inhibition	—
Avian Influenza H5N1	Inhibition	—
Avian Influenza H9N2	Inhibition	—
SARS-CoV	Inhibits replication	—

Virus Type	Inhibition Effect	Notes
SARS-CoV-2 (Novel Coronavirus)	Inhibits replication	Effective against Omicron variant
RSV (Respiratory Syncytial Virus)	Inhibition	—
Enterovirus EV71	Inhibition	—
Parainfluenza virus	Inhibition	—

Mechanism: Binds to ACE2 receptor surface on host cells, interfering with viral adsorption and entry.

4.2 Anti-inflammatory and Immune-modulating Effects

- Suppresses cytokine storm by significantly reducing TNF-alpha, IL-6, MCP-1, IP-10 and other pro-inflammatory cytokines;
- Regulates signaling pathways including MAPK1, NLRP3, HSP90AA1, TLR9;
- Protects lung tissue by reducing pulmonary inflammatory lesions and improving lung function;
- Enhances immunity by increasing CD4+ T lymphocyte count and CD4+/CD8+ ratio, promoting interferon-gamma secretion.

4.3 Antipyretic and Expectorant Effects

- **Antipyretic:** Effectively reduces febrile responses in endotoxin-induced animal models with average fever reduction time of approximately 31 hours;
- **Antitussive and Expectorant:** Promotes tracheal phenol red secretion, prolongs cough latency, improves airway secretion expulsion.

4.4 Antibacterial Activity

Shows significant inhibitory effect on Staphylococcus aureus including methicillin-resistant S. aureus (MRSA), helping prevent secondary bacterial infections.

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5. Clinical Efficacy Data

5.1 Influenza Clinical Trials

Indicator	Lianhua Qingwen Group	Control Group	Notes
Cure Rate	~70% to 85%	~45% to 60%	Significantly higher in treatment group
Effective Rate	~90% to 95%	~65% to 75%	—
Average Fever Reduction Time	31.2 hours	56.4 hours	Nearly 45% shorter
Cough Improvement	Significantly shortened	—	p less than 0.05
Course Duration	Significantly better	—	—

5.2 COVID-19 Clinical Application

- Included in Chinese Diagnosis and Treatment Protocol for Novel Coronavirus Pneumonia Trial Version 9 as a recommended medication;

- Multiple multicenter randomized controlled trials confirmed:
- Shortens duration of fever, cough, fatigue and other symptoms;
- Improves chest CT imaging findings;
- Reduces risk of progression from mild and moderate to severe disease;
- Recommended course of treatment is 7 to 10 days.

5.3 Summary of Applicable Disease Range

Disease Type	Indication
Influenza	Heat-toxin attacking lung syndrome with fever or high fever, chills, myalgia, nasal congestion, cough, headache, dry or sore throat
COVID-19	Mild and common types with fever, cough, fatigue used as adjunct therapy with 7-10 day course
Upper Respiratory Tract Infection	Acute pharyngitis, acute tonsillitis belonging to wind-heat or heat-toxin patterns

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6. Dosage and Administration

Item	Details
Route of Administration	Oral
Adult Standard Dose	4 capsules each time, 3 times daily
Recommended Timing	Take 30 minutes after meals to reduce gastrointestinal irritation

Item	Details
Severe Cases	Single dose may be increased under medical supervision
Recommended Course	7 to 10 days, not for long-term continuous use
Monitoring	If symptoms persist after 3 days of use, seek medical attention

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7. Adverse Reactions and Contraindications

7.1 Adverse Reactions (Post-marketing Surveillance)

System Category	Manifestations	Characteristics
Gastrointestinal	Nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, diarrhea, bloating	Mostly occurs in fasting administration, self-limiting after discontinuation
Allergic	Rash, pruritus	Usually appears within 30 minutes of intake, more common in first-time users
Other	Dry mouth, dizziness	Generally mild, may diminish with continued use

7.2 Contraindications

Contraindicated in persons allergic to any component of this product.

7.3 Precautions

1. Avoid tobacco, alcohol, spicy, raw, cold and greasy foods during treatment;
2. Do NOT take simultaneously with tonic Chinese herbal medicines such as Ginseng or Astragalus;
3. Avoid concurrent use with other heat-clearing drugs to prevent worsening diarrhea;
4. Not applicable to wind-cold cold patients;
5. Use with caution in hypertension and heart disease patients because it contains Ephedra which may raise blood pressure;
6. Chronic disease patients including liver disease, diabetes, kidney disease should use under physician guidance;
7. Children, pregnant or lactating women, elderly or frail persons should use under physician guidance;
8. Patients with fever over 38.5 degrees Celsius should seek hospital care rather than relying solely on this medication;
9. Strictly follow prescribed dosage, do not use long-term, seek medical help if no improvement after 3 days;
10. Allergy-prone individuals should use cautiously, athletes should use cautiously because Ephedra may trigger positive doping tests;
11. Contains Ku Xing Ren and Guan Zhong, both mildly toxic, never exceed maximum specified dosage.

7.4 Special Population Guidelines

Population	Guidance
Pregnant women	Use with caution, decision after physician evaluation
Breastfeeding mothers	Use with caution, consider pausing breastfeeding when necessary
Children	Adjust dosage under physician guidance

Population	Guidance
Elderly	Reduce dosage or use under guidance due to frailty
Hepatic or Renal impairment	Must use under physician guidance with regular monitoring
Athletes	Use with caution due to Ephedra content

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8. Internal Company Product Information

8.1 Product Overview

Item	Details
Product Name	Lianhua Qingwen Capsules
Brand	Lianhua Qingwen
Specification	0.35g x 24 capsules
Unit Price	20 yuan per box (24 capsules per box)

8.2 Inventory Status

Batch No.	Current Stock (capsules)	Warehouse Location	Production Date	Expiry Date
MY-250101-A	10,000	Tianjin Warehouse #2 - Epidemic Prevention Zone	2025-01-01	2027-01-01

Batch No.	Current Stock (capsules)	Warehouse Location	Production Date	Expiry Date
MY-250615-B	50,000	Beijing Warehouse #2 - Epidemic Prevention Zone	2025-06-15	2027-06-14
MY-251120-C	100,000	Tianjin Warehouse #1 - Epidemic Prevention Zone	2025-11-20	2027-11-19

Total Inventory: 160,000 capsules across 3 batches and 3 warehouses. All batches valid until 2027 with no expiry risk.

8.3 Sales Summary

Sales Date	Quantity Sold (boxes)	Unit Price (yuan)	Total Amount (yuan)	Customer	Region
2025-01-10	10,000	20.00	200,000.00	Shijiazhuang Yiling Pharma	North China
2025-12-20	50,000	20.00	1,000,000.00	National Pharmacy Chain HQ	Nationwide

Sales Totals: Cumulative sales of 60,000 boxes generating 1,200,000.00 yuan (1.2 million yuan).

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9. Summary and Key Reminders

Lianhua Qingwen Capsules is a classic traditional Chinese medicine comprising 13 herbs, with core actions of clearing plague toxins, detoxifying, disseminating lung Qi and purging heat. It is widely applied in the treatment of influenza and COVID-19, supported by clear pharmacological mechanisms including broad-spectrum antiviral activity, anti-inflammation, and immune modulation.

Correct Usage Guidelines:

1. **Syndrome Differentiation:** Only for "Heat-toxin attacking lung syndrome", contraindicated in wind-cold cases;
2. **Proper Dosage:** 4 capsules, 3 times daily, taken after meals, 7-10 day course;
3. **Monitor for Reactions:** Watch for gastrointestinal symptoms and allergic reactions, discontinue and seek care if adverse effects occur;
4. **Realistic Expectations:** This is a treatment drug, NOT prophylaxis, healthy individuals need not take it;
5. **Medical Supervision:** Special populations including children, pregnant women, chronic disease patients MUST use under physician guidance.

References

1. Lianhua Qingwen Capsules National Drug Standards
2. Chinese Diagnosis and Treatment Protocol for Novel Coronavirus Pneumonia Trial Version 9
3. Yiling Pharmaceutical Co., Ltd. Product Insert
4. Clinical Guidelines by Chinese Medical Association of Materia Medica
5. Wohua Pharmaceutical Internal Database Product Information

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